

REFERENCE

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1. Setup

- To print n decimals: `cout << fixed << setprecision(n);`

Bash script for compilation and execution

setup/compilation.sh

```
1  co() { g++ -std=c++20 -O2 -Wall -Wextra -Wshadow -Wconversion -o $1
   $1.cpp; }
2
3  run() { co $1 && ./$1; }
```

C++ template

setup/template.cpp

```
1  #include <bits/stdc++.h>
2
3  using namespace std;
4
5  #define endl '\n'
6  #define dbg(x) cout << #x << ": " << x << endl
7  #define sz(x) int((x).size())
8  #define all(v) v.begin(), v.end()
9  #define rall(v) v.rbegin(), v.rend()
10 #define pb push_back
11 #define mp make_pair
12 #define fi first
13 #define se second
14
15 using ll = long long;
16 const ll INF = 1e18;
17 const ll MOD = 1e9 + 7;
```

2. Data structures

2.1. Prefix Sums

2.1.1. 2D Prefix Sums

To process Q queries for the sum over a subrectangle of a 2D matrix with N rows and M columns

$$\text{prefix}[a][b] = \sum_{i=1}^a \sum_{j=1}^b \text{arr}[i][j]$$

This can be calculated as follows for row index $1 \leq i \leq n$ and column index $1 \leq j \leq m$:

$$\text{prefix}[i][j] = \text{prefix}[i-1][j] + \text{prefix}[i][j-1] - \text{prefix}[i-1][j-1] + \text{arr}[i][j]$$

The submatrix sum between rows a and A and columns b and B , can thus be expressed as follows:

$$\sum_{i=a}^A \sum_{j=b}^B \text{arr}[i][j] = \text{prefix}[A][B] - \text{prefix}[a-1][B] - \text{prefix}[A][b-1] + \text{prefix}[a-1][b-1]$$

2.1.2. Max Subarray Sum

Given an array of integers, find the maximum sum subarray

Kadane's algorithm

TIME
 $O(n)$

data_structures/kadane.cpp

```
6  int main() {
7      int n;
8      cin >> n;
9      vector<long long> x(n);
10     for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) { cin >> x[i]; }
11     ll current_sum = x[0];
12     ll max_subarray_sum = x[0];
13     for (int i = 1; i < n; i++) {
14         /*
15          * Continue the subarray sum or start a new
16          * subarray sum beginning at the current element.
17          */
```

```

18     current_sum = max(current_sum + x[i], x[i]);
19     // Store the maximum subarray sum at each iteration.
20     max_subarray_sum = max(max_subarray_sum, current_sum);
21 }
22 cout << max_subarray_sum << endl;
23 }

```

2.2. Disjoin Set Union

Find representative with path compression

TIME
 $O(\log n)$

data_structures/dsu_size.cpp ↗

```

11 int find(int v) {
12     if (v == parent[v])
13         return v;
14     return parent[v] = find(parent[v]);
15 }

```

Union by size

TIME
 $O(\alpha(m, n))$

data_structures/dsu_size.cpp ↗

```

17 DSU_size(int n) : parent(n), size(n, 1) {
18     for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) { parent[i] = i; }
19 }
20
21 bool unite(int a, int b) {
22     a = find(a);
23     b = find(b);
24
25     if (a == b) return false;
26
27     if (size[a] < size[b])
28         swap(a, b);
29     parent[b] = a;
30     size[a] += size[b];
31
32     return true;

```

```

33 }

```

Union by rank

TIME
 $O(\alpha(m, n))$

data_structures/dsu_rank.cpp ↗

```

17 DSU_rank(int n) : parent(n), rank(n, 0) {
18     for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) { parent[i] = i; }
19 }
20
21 bool unite(int a, int b) {
22     a = find(a);
23     b = find(b);
24
25     if (a == b) return false;
26
27     if (rank[a] < rank[b])
28         swap(a, b);
29     parent[b] = a;
30     if (rank[a] == rank[b])
31         rank[a]++;
32
33     return true;
34 }

```

2.3. Segment tree

Implementation

TIME

- $O(n)$ for building
- $O(\log n)$ for queries and updates

data_structures/segment-tree.cpp ↗

```

6 int n, t[4*MAXN];
7
8 void build(int a[], int v, int tl, int tr) {
9     if (tl == tr) {
10         t[v] = a[tl];
11     } else {
12         int tm = (tl + tr) / 2;

```

```

13     build(a, v*2, tl, tm);
14     build(a, v*2+1, tm+1, tr);
15     t[v] = t[v*2] + t[v*2+1];
16 }
17 }
18
19 int sum(int v, int tl, int tr, int l, int r) {
20     if (l > r)
21         return 0;
22     if (l == tl && r == tr) {
23         return t[v];
24     }
25     int tm = (tl + tr) / 2;
26     return sum(v*2, tl, tm, l, min(r, tm))
27         + sum(v*2+1, tm+1, tr, max(l, tm+1), r);
28 }
29
30 void update(int v, int tl, int tr, int pos, int new_val) {
31     if (tl == tr) {
32         t[v] = new_val;
33     } else {
34         int tm = (tl + tr) / 2;
35         if (pos <= tm)
36             update(v*2, tl, tm, pos, new_val);
37         else
38             update(v*2+1, tm+1, tr, pos, new_val);
39         t[v] = t[v*2] + t[v*2+1];
40     }
41 }

```

3. Sorting & Searching

3.1. Two Pointers

Some uses:

Subarray sum: Given an array of n positive integers and a target sum x , and we want to find a subarray whose sum is x or report that there is no such subarray.

2SUM Problem: Given an array of n numbers and a target sum x , find two array values such that their sum is x , or report that no such values exist.

Merging two sorted arrays: Given two arrays, sorted in ascending order combine the elements of these arrays into one big array.

```

1 while i < a.size() || j < b.size():
2     if a[i] < b[j]:
3         c[i + j] = a[i]
4         i++
5     else:
6         c[i + j] = b[j]
7         j++

```

Number of Smaller: We have two arrays a and b . We want to calculate for each element b_j how many such i exist that $a_i < b_j$.

```

1 i = 0
2 for j = 0..b.size()-1:
3     while i < a.size() && a[i] < b[j]:
4         i++
5     res[j] = i

```

3.2. Binary Search on Monotonic Functions

Finding The Maximum x Such That $f(x) = \text{true}$

TIME
 $O(\log n)$

```

                                sorting_searching/last_true.cpp
1  #include <bits/stdc++.h>
2  using namespace std;
3
4  int last_true(int lo, int hi, function<bool(int)> f) {
5      // if none of the values in the range work, return lo - 1
6      lo--;
7      while (lo < hi) {
8          // find the middle of the current range (rounding up)
9          int mid = lo + (hi - lo + 1) / 2;
10         if (f(mid)) {
11             // if mid works, then all numbers smaller than mid also
            work
12             lo = mid;
13         } else {
14             // if mid does not work, greater values would not work
            either

```

```

15         hi = mid - 1;
16     }
17 }
18     return lo;
19 }
20
21 int main() {
22     // all numbers satisfy the condition (outputs 10)
23     cout << last_true(2, 10, [](int x) { return true; }) << endl;
24
25     // outputs 5
26     cout << last_true(2, 10, [](int x) { return x * x ≤ 30; }) <<
    endl;
27
28     // no numbers satisfy the condition (outputs 1)
29     cout << last_true(2, 10, [](int x) { return false; }) << endl;
30 }

```

Finding The Minimum x Such That $f(x) = \text{true}$

TIME
 $O(\log n)$

sorting_searching/first_true.cpp ↗

```

1  #include <bits/stdc++.h>
2  using namespace std;
3
4  int first_true(int lo, int hi, function<bool(int)> f) {
5      hi++;
6      while (lo < hi) {
7          int mid = lo + (hi - lo) / 2;
8          if (f(mid)) {
9              hi = mid;
10         } else {
11             lo = mid + 1;
12         }
13     }
14     return lo;
15 }
16
17 int main() {
18     // outputs 2
19     cout << first_true(2, 10, [](int x) { return true; }) << endl;

```

```

20     // outputs 6
21     cout << first_true(2, 10, [](int x) { return x * x ≥ 30; }) <<
    endl;
22     // outputs 11
23     cout << first_true(2, 10, [](int x) { return false; }) << endl;
24 }

```

4. Bit Manipulation

4.1. Bit mask

A *bit mask* of the form $1 \ll k$ has a one bit in position k and all other bits are zero (zero-indexed from right to left). For **long long**, use $1LL \ll k$.

Manipulating individual bits:

- $x \mid (1 \ll k)$: Sets the k th bit of x to one.
- $x \& \sim(1 \ll k)$: Sets the k th bit of x to zero.
- $x \wedge (1 \ll k)$: Inverts the k th bit of x .

Working with the rightmost 1-bit:

- $x \& -x$: Isolates the rightmost set bit (keeps only the least significant bit that is 1, sets all others to 0).
- $x \& (x - 1)$: Removes the rightmost set bit from x (turns the rightmost 1 to 0).
- $x \mid (x - 1)$: Sets all trailing zeros of x to 1.

Creating useful bit masks:

- $(1 \ll n) - 1$: Creates a bit mask with the first n bits set to 1.

Common bit manipulation tricks:

- A positive number x is a power of two exactly when $x \& (x - 1) = 0$.
- $x \wedge A \wedge B$: Determines which is not the current value of x between A and B .

Bit operations as math alternatives:

- $x \ll k$: equivalent to $x * \text{pow}(2, k)$
- $x \gg k$: equivalent to $x / \text{pow}(2, k)$ (integer division)
- $x \& ((1 \ll k) - 1)$: equivalent to $x \% \text{pow}(2, k)$
- $A + B$: equivalent to $(A \wedge B) + 2 * (A \& B)$ or $(A \mid B) + (A \& B)$

GNU C++ compiler built-in functions:

- `__builtin_clz(x)`: the number of leading zeros (zeros on the left side of the bit representation).
- `__builtin_ctz(x)`: the number of trailing zeros (zeros on the right side of the bit representation).
- `__builtin_popcount(x)`: the number of ones in the bit representation.

`__builtin_parity(x)`: the parity (even or odd) of the number of ones in the bit representation.

Example of use

```
1 int x = 5328; // 000000000000000000001010011010000
2 cout << __builtin_clz(x) << "\n"; // 19
3 cout << __builtin_ctz(x) << "\n"; // 4
4 cout << __builtin_popcount(x) << "\n"; // 5
5 cout << __builtin_parity(x) << "\n"; // 1
```

Note

The above functions only support `int` numbers, but there are also `long long` versions of the functions available with the suffix `ll` (e.g. `__builtin_popcountll(x)`).

4.2. Representing Sets

Every subset of a set $\{0, 1, 2, \dots, n - 1\}$ can be represented as an n bit integer whose one bits indicate which elements belong to the subset.

Example. The bit representation of the set $\{1, 3, 4, 8\}$ is

000000000000000000000000100011010

Prints the size of the set {1,3,4,8}

```
1 int x = 0;
2 x |= (1<<1);
3 x |= (1<<3);
4 x |= (1<<4);
5 x |= (1<<8);
6 cout << __builtin_popcount(x) << "\n"; // 4
```

Prints all elements that belong to the set

```
1 for (int i = 0; i < 32; i++) {
2     if (x & (1<<i)) cout << i << " ";
3 }
4 // output: 1 3 4 8
```

Set operations:

Operation	Set syntax	Bit syntax
Intersection	$a \cap b$	<code>a & b</code>

Operation	Set syntax	Bit syntax
Union	$a \cup b$	<code>a b</code>
Complement	$\bar{a}$	<code>~a</code>
Difference	$a \setminus b$	<code>a & (~b)</code>

Goes through the subsets of $\{0, 1, \dots, n - 1\}$

```
1 for (int b = 0; b < (1<<n); b++) {
2     // process subset b
3 }
```

Goes through the subsets with exactly k elements

```
1 for (int b = 0; b < (1<<n); b++) {
2     if (__builtin_popcount(b) == k) {
3         // process subset b
4     }
5 }
```

Goes through the subsets of a set x

```
1 int b = 0;
2 do {
3     // process subset b
4 } while (b = (b - x) & x);
```

The idea is that the formula $b - x$ detects the rightmost one bit in x that is zero in b . This bit becomes one and all bits after it become zero. Then the and operation ensures that the resulting value is a subset of x . Note that $b - x$ equals $-(x - b)$ so we can think that we first remove all one bits that appear in b and then invert the value and add one.

C++ Bitsets: The `bitset` structure corresponds to an array whose each value is either 0 or 1.

Creates a `bitset` of 10 elements

```
1 bitset<10> s;
2 s[1] = 1;
3 s[3] = 1;
4 s[4] = 1;
5 s[7] = 1;
6 cout << s[4] << "\n"; // 1
7 cout << s[5] << "\n"; // 0
```

Returns the number of one bits in the bitset



```
1 cout << s.count() << "\n"; // 4
```

Bit operations can be directly used to manipulate bitsets



```
1 bitset<10> a, b;
2 // ...
3 bitset<10> c = a&b;
4 bitset<10> d = a|b;
5 bitset<10> e = a^b;
```

5. Graphs

5.1. Graph Traversal

5.1.1. Floodfill

Flood fill is an algorithm that identifies and labels the connected component that a particular cell belongs to in a multidimensional array.

⚠ Warning

Recursive implementations of flood fill sometimes lead to

- Memory limit exceeded if you run the recursive implementation on a really big grid (i.e., running the above code on a 4000 × 4000 grid may exceed 256 MB)
- Non-recursive implementations generally use less memory than recursive ones.

Example (recursive implementation)

graphs/floodfill_recursive.cpp

```
1 const int MAX_N = 1000;
2
3 int grid[MAX_N][MAX_N]; // the grid itself
4 int row_num;
5 int col_num;
6 bool visited[MAX_N][MAX_N]; // keeps track of which nodes have been
  visited
7 int curr_size = 0;          // reset to 0 each time we start a new
  component
8
```

```
9 void floodfill(int r, int c, int color) {
10     if ((r < 0 || r >= row_num || c < 0 || c >= col_num) // if out
        of bounds
11         || grid[r][c] != color // wrong
        color
12         || visited[r][c] // already
        visited this square
13     )
14         return;
15
16     visited[r][c] = true; // mark current square as visited
17     curr_size++;          // increment the size for each square we
        visit
18
19     // recursively call flood fill for neighboring squares
20     floodfill(r, c + 1, color);
21     floodfill(r, c - 1, color);
22     floodfill(r - 1, c, color);
23     floodfill(r + 1, c, color);
24 }
25
26 int main() {
27     /*
28     * input code and other problem-specific stuff here
29     */
30     for (int i = 0; i < row_num; i++) {
31         for (int j = 0; j < col_num; j++) {
32             if (!visited[i][j]) {
33                 curr_size = 0;
34                 /*
35                 * start a flood fill if the square hasn't already
36                 * been visited,
37                 * and then store or otherwise use the component size
38                 * for whatever it's needed for
39                 */
39                 floodfill(i, j, grid[i][j]);
40             }
41         }
42     }
43     return 0;
44 }
```

Example (iterative implementation)

graphs/floodfill_iterative.cpp



```

1  #include <bits/stdc++.h>
2
3  using namespace std;
4
5  const int MAX_N = 2500;
6  const int R_CHANGE[]{0, 1, 0, -1};
7  const int C_CHANGE[]{1, 0, -1, 0};
8
9  int row_num;
10 int col_num;
11 string building[MAX_N];
12 bool visited[MAX_N][MAX_N];
13
14 void floodfill(int r, int c) {
15     // Note: you can also use a queue and pop from the front for a
16     // BFS-based
17     // approach
18     stack<pair<int, int>> frontier;
19     frontier.push({r, c});
20     while (!frontier.empty()) {
21         r = frontier.top().first;
22         c = frontier.top().second;
23         frontier.pop();
24
25         if (r < 0 || r >= row_num || c < 0 || c >= col_num ||
26             building[r][c] == '#' ||
27             visited[r][c])
28             continue;
29
30         visited[r][c] = true;
31         for (int i = 0; i < 4; i++) {
32             frontier.push({r + R_CHANGE[i], c + C_CHANGE[i]});
33         }
34     }
35 }
36
37 int main() {
38     cin >> row_num >> col_num;
39     for (int i = 0; i < row_num; i++) { cin >> building[i]; }

```

```

38
39     int room_num = 0;
40     for (int i = 0; i < row_num; i++) {
41         for (int j = 0; j < col_num; j++) {
42             if (building[i][j] == '.' && !visited[i][j]) {
43                 floodfill(i, j);
44                 room_num++;
45             }
46         }
47     }
48     cout << room_num << endl;
49 }

```

5.2. Topological Sort

A topological sort of a directed acyclic graph is a linear ordering of its vertices such that for every directed edge $u \rightarrow v$ from vertex u to vertex v , u comes before v in the ordering.

DFS Version

graphs/topological_sort_dfs.cpp



```

1  #include <bits/stdc++.h>
2
3  using namespace std;
4
5  vector<int> top_sort;
6  vector<vector<int>> graph;
7  vector<bool> visited;
8
9  void dfs(int node) {
10     for (int next : graph[node]) {
11         if (!visited[next]) {
12             visited[next] = true;
13             dfs(next);
14         }
15     }
16     top_sort.push_back(node);
17 }
18
19 int main() {
20     int n, m; // The number of nodes and edges respectively

```



```

21     cin >> n >> m;
22
23     graph = vector<vector<int>>>(n);
24     for (int i = 0; i < m; i++) {
25         int a, b;
26         cin >> a >> b;
27         graph[a - 1].push_back(b - 1);
28     }
29
30     visited = vector<bool>(n);
31     for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {
32         if (!visited[i]) {
33             visited[i] = true;
34             dfs(i);
35         }
36     }
37     reverse(top_sort.begin(), top_sort.end());
38
39     vector<int> ind(n);
40     for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) { ind[top_sort[i]] = i; }
41
42     // Check if the topological sort is valid
43     bool valid = true;
44     for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {
45         for (int j : graph[i]) {
46             if (ind[j] <= ind[i]) {
47                 valid = false;
48                 goto answer;
49             }
50         }
51     }
52     answer::;
53
54     if (valid) {
55         for (int i = 0; i < n - 1; i++) { cout << top_sort[i] + 1 <<
56             ' '; }
57         cout << top_sort.back() + 1 << endl;
58     } else {
59         cout << "IMPOSSIBLE" << endl;
60     }

```

BFS Version (Kahn's Algorithm)

```

graphs/topological_sort_bfs.cpp ↗
1  #include <bits/stdc++.h>
2
3  using namespace std;
4
5  int main() {
6      int n, m;
7      cin >> n >> m;
8
9      vector<vector<int>>> graph(n);
10     for (int i = 0; i < m; i++) {
11         int a, b;
12         cin >> a >> b;
13         graph[a - 1].push_back(b - 1);
14     }
15
16     vector<int> in_degree(n);
17     for (const vector<int> &nodes : graph) {
18         for (int node : nodes) { in_degree[node]++; }
19     }
20
21     queue<int> queue;
22     for (int i = 0; i < n; i++) {
23         if (in_degree[i] == 0) { queue.push(i); }
24     }
25     vector<int> top_sort;
26     while (!queue.empty()) {
27         int curr = queue.front();
28         queue.pop();
29         top_sort.push_back(curr);
30         for (int next : graph[curr]) {
31             if (--in_degree[next] == 0) { queue.push(next); }
32         }
33     }
34
35     if (top_sort.size() == n) {
36         for (int i = 0; i < n - 1; i++) { cout << top_sort[i] + 1 <<
37             ' '; }
38         cout << top_sort.back() + 1 << endl;

```

```
38     } else {
39         cout << "IMPOSSIBLE" << endl;
40     }
41 }
```

6. Number Theory

The *prime-counting function* $\pi(n)$ gives the number of primes up to n .

$$\pi(n) \approx \frac{n}{\ln(n)}$$

6.1. Primes and Factors

For every integer $n > 1$, there is a unique prime factorization

$$n = p_1^{\alpha_1} p_2^{\alpha_2} \dots p_k^{\alpha_k}$$

Number of factors of an integer n

$$\tau(n) = \prod_{i=1}^k (\alpha_i + 1)$$

Sum of factors of an integer n

$$\sigma(n) = \prod_{i=1}^k (1 + p_i + \dots + p_i^{\alpha_i}) = \prod_{i=1}^k \frac{p_i^{\alpha_i+1} - 1}{p_i - 1}$$

6.2. Sieve of Eratosthenes

Sieve with basic optimizations

TIME
 $O(n \log \log n)$

SPACE
 $O(n)$

Find all the prime numbers in $[1, n]$. This code uses the next optimizations:

- Sieving till root
- Sieving by the odd numbers only

[number_theory/sieve_with_basic_optimizations.cpp](#)

```
1 #include <bits/stdc++.h>
2 using namespace std;
3
4 vector<bool> sieve(int n) {
```

```
5     vector<bool> is_prime(n + 1, true);
6     is_prime[0] = is_prime[1] = false;
7     for (int i = 3; i * i <= n; i += 2) {
8         if (is_prime[i]) {
9             for (int j = i * i; j <= n; j += 2 * i)
10                 is_prime[j] = false;
11         }
12     }
13     return is_prime;
14 }
```

6.3. Euclid's Algorithm

The algorithm is based on the formula

$$\gcd(a, b) = \begin{cases} a & b = 0 \\ \gcd(b, a \bmod b) & b \neq 0 \end{cases}$$

6.3.1. Extended Euclid's Algorithm:

Euclid's algorithm can also be extended so that it gives integers x and y for which

$$ax + by = \gcd(a, b)$$

Iterative version

TIME
 $O(\log \min(a, b))$

[number_theory/extended_euclid_algorithm.cpp](#)

```
1 int gcd(int a, int b, int& x, int& y) {
2     x = 1, y = 0;
3     int x1 = 0, y1 = 1, a1 = a, b1 = b;
4     while (b1) {
5         int q = a1 / b1;
6         tie(x, x1) = make_tuple(x1, x - q * x1);
7         tie(y, y1) = make_tuple(y1, y - q * y1);
8         tie(a1, b1) = make_tuple(b1, a1 - q * b1);
9     }
10    return a1;
11 }
```

6.4. Euler's Theorem

Euler's totient function $\varphi(n)$ gives the number of integers between $1, \dots, n$ that are coprime to n .

Any value of $\varphi(n)$ can be calculated from the prime factorization of n using the formula

$$\varphi(n) = \prod_{i=1}^k p_i^{\alpha_i-1} (p_i - 1)$$

Theorem 6.4.1 (Euler's theorem)

For all positive coprime integers x and m

$$x^{\varphi(m)} \bmod m = 1$$

If m is prime, $\varphi(m) = m - 1$, so the formula becomes

$$x^{m-1} \bmod m = 1$$

which is known as *Fermat's little theorem*. This also implies that

$$x^n \bmod m = x^{n \bmod (m-1)} \bmod m$$

which can be used to calculate values of x^n if n is very large.

Definition 6.4.2 (Modular multiplicative inverse)

The *modular multiplicative inverse* of x with respect to m is a value $\text{inv}_m(x)$ such that

$$x \cdot \text{inv}_m(x) \bmod m = 1$$

A modular multiplicative inverse exists exactly when x and m are coprime. In this case it can be calculated using the formula

$$\text{inv}_m(x) = x^{\varphi(m)-1}$$

In particular, if m is prime, $\varphi(m) = m - 1$ and the formula becomes

$$\text{inv}_m(x) = x^{m-2}$$

The above formula allows us to efficiently calculate modular multiplicative inverses using the modular exponentiation algorithm.

6.5. Solving Equations

Definition 6.5.1 (Diophantine equation)

A *Diophantine equation* is an equation of the form

$$ax + by = c$$

where a , b and c are constants and the values of x and y should be found. Each number in the equation has to be an integer.

We can efficiently solve a Diophantine equation by using the extended Euclid's algorithm which gives integers x and y that satisfy the equation

$$ax + by = \gcd(a, b)$$

A Diophantine equation can be solved exactly when c is divisible by $\gcd(a, b)$.

If a pair (x, y) is a solution, then also all pairs

$$\left(x + \frac{kb}{\gcd(a, b)}, y - \frac{ka}{\gcd(a, b)} \right)$$

are solutions, where k is any integer.

7. Combinatorics

7.1. Binomial Coefficients

Note

For $n < k$ the value of $\binom{n}{k}$ is assumed to be zero.

7.1.1. Properties

Pascal's Triangle:

$$\binom{n}{k} = \binom{n-1}{k-1} + \binom{n-1}{k}$$

Symmetry rule:

$$\binom{n}{k} = \binom{n}{n-k}$$

Factoring in:

$$\binom{n}{k} = \frac{n}{k} \binom{n-1}{k-1}$$

Sum over k :

$$\sum_{k=0}^n \binom{n}{k} = 2^n$$

Sum over n :

$$\sum_{m=0}^n \binom{m}{k} = \binom{n+1}{k+1}$$

Sum over n and k :

$$\sum_{k=0}^m \binom{n+k}{k} = \binom{n+m+1}{m}$$

Sum of the squares:

$$\binom{n}{0}^2 + \binom{n}{1}^2 + \dots + \binom{n}{n}^2 = \binom{2n}{n}$$

Weighted sum:

$$1\binom{n}{1} + 2\binom{n}{2} + \dots + n\binom{n}{n} = n2^{n-1}$$

Connection with the Fibonacci numbers:

$$\binom{n}{0} + \binom{n-1}{1} + \dots + \binom{n-k}{k} + \dots + \binom{0}{n} = F_{n+1}$$

7.1.2. Calculation

Basic Improved Implementation



```
1 int C(int n, int k) {
2     double res = 1;
3     for (int i = 1; i ≤ k; ++i)
4         res = res * (n - k + i) / i;
5     return (int)(res + 0.01);
6 }
```

Table of binomial coefficients using Pascal's Triangle identity



```
1 const int maxn = ...;
2 int C[maxn + 1][maxn + 1];
3 C[0][0] = 1;
4 for (int n = 1; n ≤ maxn; ++n) {
5     C[n][0] = C[n][n] = 1;
6     for (int k = 1; k < n; ++k)
7         C[n][k] = C[n - 1][k - 1] + C[n - 1][k];
8 }
```

7.1.2.1. Binomial coefficient modulo prime power

$$\binom{n}{k} \bmod p \equiv (n!) \operatorname{inv}_p((n-k)!) \operatorname{inv}_p(k!) \bmod p$$

$$\operatorname{inv}_p((x-1)!) \equiv x * \operatorname{inv}_p(x!) \bmod p$$

8. Utilities

8.1. Strings

Method/Syntax	Description	Complexity	Example
<code>s.size()</code> / <code>s.length()</code>	Returns the number of characters	$O(1)$	<code>int n = s.size();</code>
<code>s.empty()</code>	Checks if string is empty	$O(1)$	<code>if (s.empty()) { ... }</code>
<code>s[i]</code> / <code>s.at(i)</code>	Access character at position <code>i</code>	$O(1)$	<code>char c = s[0];</code>
<code>s.front()</code> / <code>s.back()</code>	Access first/last character	$O(1)$	<code>char first = s.front();</code>
<code>s.push_back(c)</code>	Appends character to end	$O(1)$ amortized	<code>s.push_back('x');</code>
<code>s.pop_back()</code>	Removes last character	$O(1)$	<code>s.pop_back();</code>
<code>s += str</code> / <code>s.append(str)</code>	Concatenates string/character	$O(m)$	<code>s += "hello";</code>
<code>s.insert(pos, str)</code>	Inserts string at position	$O(n+m)$	<code>s.insert(2, "abc");</code>
<code>s.erase(pos, len)</code>	Removes <code>len</code> characters from <code>pos</code>	$O(n)$	<code>s.erase(2, 3);</code>
<code>s.substr(pos, len)</code>	Returns substring from <code>pos</code> with <code>len</code> chars	$O(len)$	<code>string sub = s.substr(2, 5);</code>
<code>s.find(str, pos)</code>	Finds first occurrence of <code>str</code> from <code>pos</code>	$O(n*m)$	<code>size_t pos = s.find("abc");</code>
<code>s.rfind(str, pos)</code>	Finds last occurrence of <code>str</code> before <code>pos</code>	$O(n*m)$	<code>size_t pos = s.rfind("abc");</code>
<code>s.find_first_of(chars)</code>	Finds first occurrence of any char in <code>chars</code>	$O(n*m)$	<code>s.find_first_of("aeiou");</code>
<code>s.find_last_of(chars)</code>	Finds last occurrence of any char in <code>chars</code>	$O(n*m)$	<code>s.find_last_of("aeiou");</code>
<code>s.find_first_not_of(chars)</code>	Finds first char not in <code>chars</code>	$O(n*m)$	<code>s.find_first_not_of(" \t");</code>
<code>s.find_last_not_of(chars)</code>	Finds last char not in <code>chars</code>	$O(n*m)$	<code>s.find_last_not_of(" \t");</code>
<code>s.replace(pos, len, str)</code>	Replaces <code>len</code> chars at <code>pos</code> with <code>str</code>	$O(n+m)$	<code>s.replace(2, 3, "xyz");</code>
<code>s.compare(str)</code>	Lexicographically compares strings	$O(\min(n,m))$	<code>int cmp = s.compare("abc");</code>
<code>s.c_str()</code>	Returns C-style null-terminated string	$O(1)$	<code>const char* cstr = s.c_str();</code>
<code>s.data()</code>	Returns pointer to character array	$O(1)$	<code>char* ptr = s.data();</code>
<code>s.reserve(n)</code>	Reserves capacity for <code>n</code> characters	$O(1)$	<code>s.reserve(1000);</code>
<code>s.resize(n, c)</code>	Changes size to <code>n</code> , filling with <code>c</code> if needed	$O(n)$	<code>s.resize(10, 'x');</code>
<code>s.clear()</code>	Removes all characters	$O(n)$	<code>s.clear();</code>
<code>s.swap(other)</code>	Swaps contents with another string	$O(1)$	<code>s.swap(t);</code>
<code>getline(cin, s)</code>	Reads entire line including spaces	$O(n)$	<code>getline(cin, s);</code>
<code>getline(cin, s, delim)</code>	Reads until delimiter character	$O(n)$	<code>getline(cin, s, ',');</code>
<code>stoi(s)</code> / <code>stol(s)</code> / <code>stoll(s)</code>	Converts string to int/long/long long	$O(n)$	<code>int num = stoi("123");</code>
<code>stof(s)</code> / <code>stod(s)</code>	Converts string to float/double	$O(n)$	<code>double d = stod("3.14");</code>
<code>to_string(num)</code>	Converts number to string	$O(\log \text{ num})$	<code>string s = to_string(42);</code>

<code>isalpha(c) / isdigit(c)</code>	Checks if char is letter/digit	O(1)	<code>if (isalpha(s[i])) { ... }</code>
<code>islower(c) / isupper(c)</code>	Checks if char is lowercase/uppercase	O(1)	<code>if (islower(s[i])) { ... }</code>
<code>tolower(c) / toupper(c)</code>	Converts char to lowercase/uppercase	O(1)	<code>s[i] = tolower(s[i]);</code>
<code>isspace(c)</code>	Checks if char is whitespace	O(1)	<code>if (isspace(s[i])) { ... }</code>
<code>isalnum(c)</code>	Checks if char is alphanumeric	O(1)	<code>if (isalnum(s[i])) { ... }</code>

8.1.1. Important Notes:

- **String indexing:** Use `s[i]` for fast access, `s.at(i)` for bounds checking
- **Find functions:** Return `string::npos` if not found (usually -1 or large value)
- **Character functions:** `isalpha`, `isdigit`, etc. are in `<cctype>` header
- **Conversion functions:** `stoi`, `to_string`, etc. are in `<string>` header
- **Amortized complexity:** `push_back` is O(1) on average due to capacity doubling

8.1.2. Useful Patterns:

```

1 // Check if substring exists
2 if (s.find("pattern") != string::npos) { ... }
3
4 // Convert string to lowercase
5 transform(s.begin(), s.end(), s.begin(), [](char c) { return tolower(c); });
6
7 // Split string by delimiter
8 stringstream ss(s); string token;
9 while (getline(ss, token, ',')) { ... }
10
11 // Remove leading/trailing whitespace
12 s.erase(0, s.find_first_not_of(" \t"));
13 s.erase(s.find_last_not_of(" \t") + 1);
14
15 // Reverse string
16 reverse(s.begin(), s.end());

```

8.2. STL Algorithm

Function/Syntax	Description	Complexity	Example
<code>sort(begin, end)</code>	Sorts elements in ascending order	O(n log n)	<code>sort(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>stable_sort(begin, end)</code>	Sorts maintaining relative order of equal elements	O(n log n)	<code>stable_sort(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>reverse(begin, end)</code>	Reverses the order of elements	O(n)	<code>reverse(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>binary_search(begin, end, val)</code>	Searches for value in sorted range (returns bool)	O(log n)	<code>binary_search(v.begin(), v.end(), x)</code>

<code>lower_bound(begin, end, val)</code>	Finds first element $\geq$ val	$O(\log n)$	<code>lower_bound(v.begin(), v.end(), x)</code>
<code>upper_bound(begin, end, val)</code>	Finds first element $>$ val	$O(\log n)$	<code>upper_bound(v.begin(), v.end(), x)</code>
<code>equal_range(begin, end, val)</code>	Returns pair of iterators [lower_bound, upper_bound]	$O(\log n)$	<code>equal_range(v.begin(), v.end(), x)</code>
<code>min_element(begin, end)</code>	Finds iterator to minimum element	$O(n)$	<code>min_element(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>max_element(begin, end)</code>	Finds iterator to maximum element	$O(n)$	<code>max_element(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>minmax_element(begin, end)</code>	Returns pair {min_iter, max_iter}	$O(n)$	<code>minmax_element(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>next_permutation(begin, end)</code>	Generates next lexicographic permutation	$O(n)$	<code>next_permutation(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>prev_permutation(begin, end)</code>	Generates previous lexicographic permutation	$O(n)$	<code>prev_permutation(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>unique(begin, end)</code>	Removes consecutive duplicate elements	$O(n)$	<code>unique(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>count(begin, end, val)</code>	Counts occurrences of a value	$O(n)$	<code>count(v.begin(), v.end(), x)</code>
<code>count_if(begin, end, pred)</code>	Counts elements satisfying condition	$O(n)$	<code>count_if(v.begin(), v.end(), [](int x){return x%2==0;})</code>
<code>find(begin, end, val)</code>	Finds first occurrence of value	$O(n)$	<code>find(v.begin(), v.end(), x)</code>
<code>find_if(begin, end, pred)</code>	Finds first element satisfying condition	$O(n)$	<code>find_if(v.begin(), v.end(), [](int x){return x>5;})</code>
<code>rotate(begin, middle, end)</code>	Rotates elements (middle becomes new begin)	$O(n)$	<code>rotate(v.begin(), v.begin()+k, v.end())</code>
<code>random_shuffle(begin, end)</code>	Shuffles elements randomly	$O(n)$	<code>random_shuffle(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>shuffle(begin, end, rng)</code>	Shuffles with specific random generator	$O(n)$	<code>shuffle(v.begin(), v.end(), rng)</code>
<code>fill(begin, end, val)</code>	Fills range with a value	$O(n)$	<code>fill(v.begin(), v.end(), 0)</code>
<code>iota(begin, end, val)</code>	Fills with consecutive values starting from val	$O(n)$	<code>iota(v.begin(), v.end(), 1)</code>
<code>accumulate(begin, end, init)</code>	Sums elements (requires <code><numeric></code>)	$O(n)$	<code>accumulate(v.begin(), v.end(), 0)</code>
<code>partial_sum(begin, end, out)</code>	Calculates partial sums	$O(n)$	<code>partial_sum(v.begin(), v.end(), prefix.begin())</code>
<code>merge(begin1, end1, begin2, end2, out)</code>	Merges two sorted ranges	$O(n+m)$	<code>merge(a.begin(), a.end(), b.begin(), b.end(), c.begin())</code>
<code>inplace_merge(begin, middle, end)</code>	Merges two sorted parts of same range	$O(n \log n)$	<code>inplace_merge(v.begin(), v.begin()+k, v.end())</code>
<code>set_union(begin1, end1, begin2, end2, out)</code>	Union of two sorted sets	$O(n+m)$	<code>set_union(a.begin(), a.end(), b.begin(), b.end(), c.begin())</code>
<code>set_intersection(begin1, end1, begin2, end2, out)</code>	Intersection of two sorted sets	$O(n+m)$	<code>set_intersection(a.begin(), a.end(), b.begin(), b.end(), c.begin())</code>
<code>set_difference(begin1, end1, begin2, end2, out)</code>	Difference of two sorted sets	$O(n+m)$	<code>set_difference(a.begin(), a.end(), b.begin(), b.end(), c.begin())</code>
<code>nth_element(begin, nth, end)</code>	Partitions so nth element is in correct position	$O(n)$ avg	<code>nth_element(v.begin(), v.begin()+k, v.end())</code>
<code>partition(begin, end, pred)</code>	Partitions elements by predicate	$O(n)$	<code>partition(v.begin(), v.end(), [](int x){return x%2==0;})</code>

<code>is_sorted(begin, end)</code>	Checks if range is sorted	$O(n)$	<code>is_sorted(v.begin(), v.end())</code>
<code>is_permutation(begin1, end1, begin2)</code>	Checks if one range is permutation of another	$O(n^2)$	<code>is_permutation(a.begin(), a.end(), b.begin())</code>

8.2.1. Important Notes:

- **Sorted ranges required:** `binary_search`, `lower_bound`, `upper_bound`, `equal_range`, `merge`, `set_*` require sorted ranges
- **<numeric> functions:** `accumulate`, `partial_sum`, `iota` are in `<numeric>`, not `<algorithm>`
- **Iterators:** Many functions return iterators. To get indices: `distance(v.begin(), iter)`
- **Predicates:** Functions like `count_if`, `find_if` accept lambdas or functors
- **Custom comparators:** Most accept custom comparators as third parameter

8.2.2. Useful Combinations:

```
1 // Sort and remove duplicates
2 sort(v.begin(), v.end());
3 v.erase(unique(v.begin(), v.end()), v.end());
```

8.3. STL containers

8.3.1. Deques

A **deque** is a dynamic array that can be efficiently manipulated at both ends of the structure.

```
1 deque<int> d;
2 d.push_back(5); // [5]
3 d.push_back(2); // [5,2]
4 d.push_front(3); // [3,5,2]
5 d.pop_back(); // [3,5]
6 d.pop_front(); // [5]
```

The operations of a deque also work in $O(1)$ average time. Deques should be used only if there is a need to manipulate both ends of the array.

8.3.2. Set Structures

The basic operations of sets are element insertion, search and removal. Sets are implemented so that all the above operations are efficient.

8.3.2.1. Sets and Multisets

Basic functions

- `insert` adds an element to the set
- `count` returns the number of occurrences of an element in the set
- `erase` removes an element from the set
- `find(x)` returns an iterator that points to an element whose value is `x`. However, if the set does not contain `x`, the iterator will be `end()`.

Prints the number of elements in a set

```
1 cout << s.size() << "\n";
```



```

2 for (auto x : s) {
3     cout << x << "\n";
4 }

```

Use of find

```

1 auto it = s.find(x);
2 if (it == s.end()) {
3     // x is not found
4 }

```

Multisets: A *multiset* is a set that can have several copies of the same value. C++ has the structures `multiset` and `unordered_multiset`.

```

1 multiset<int> s;
2 s.insert(5);
3 s.insert(5);
4 s.insert(5);
5 cout << s.count(5) << "\n"; // 3

```

The function `erase` removes all copies of a value from a multiset:

```

1 s.erase(5);
2 cout << s.count(5) << "\n"; // 0

```

Often, only one value should be removed, which can be done as follows:

```

1 s.erase(s.find(5));
2 cout << s.count(5) << "\n"; // 2

```

Note that the functions `count` and `erase` have an additional $O(k)$ factor where k is the number of elements counted/removed. In particular, it is *not* efficient to count the number of copies of a value in a multiset using the `count` function.

8.3.3. Priority Queues

Insertion and removal take $O(\log n)$ time, and retrieval takes $O(1)$ time.

If we only need to efficiently find minimum or maximum elements, it is a good idea to use a priority queue instead of a set or multiset.

By default, the elements in a C++ priority queue are sorted in decreasing order, and it is possible to find and remove the largest element in the queue.

```

1 priority_queue<int> q;
2 q.push(3);
3 q.push(5);
4 q.push(7);
5 q.push(2);
6 cout << q.top() << "\n"; // 7
7 q.pop();
8 cout << q.top() << "\n"; // 5

```

```

9  q.pop();
10 q.push(6);
11 cout << q.top() << "\n"; // 6
12 q.pop();

```

If we want to create a priority queue that supports finding and removing the smallest element, we can do it as follows:

```

1  priority_queue<int, vector<int>, greater<int>> q;

```

8.3.4. Policy-based data structures

The g++ compiler also supports some data structures that are not part of the C++ standard library. Such structures are called policy-based data structures. To use these structures, the following lines must be added to the code:

```

1  #include <ext/pb_ds/assoc_container.hpp>
2  using namespace __gnu_pbds;

```

After this, we can define a data structure `indexed_set` that is like `set` but can be indexed like an array. The definition for `int` values is as follows:

```

1  using indexed_set = tree<
2      int,
3      null_type,
4      less<int>,
5      rb_tree_tag,
6      tree_order_statistics_node_update
7  >;

```

This data structure supports all the operations as a `set` in C++ in addition to the following:

- `find_by_order(k)`: returns an iterator to the k -th smallest element (0-based indexing)
- `order_of_key(x)`: returns the number of elements in the set that are strictly less than x